

2.4 Fallback arrangements in case of failure of IT systems

Under Article 6 of the UCC, all exchanges of information between Customs Authorities and economic operators must be made using electronic data processing techniques. However, in the event of a temporary failure of either the Customs Authority or the economic operator's electronic system, the exchange of this information can be completed in a non-electronic format, which is known as 'Fallback'. There is more information on the [Customs fallback service](#) on the Revenue website.

'Fallback' is the term used to describe the business continuity process by which goods are manually cleared by Customs for import or export where an interruption to the Customs electronic systems or ROS occurs.

Revenue developed a Business Continuity Plan (BCP) for allowing the continuity of activities in case of failure of the IT systems

2.5 Modes of Importation

By sea – [Section 4](#)

By air – [Section 5](#)

Note: Since the introduction of the Single Market, there are no longer any customs reporting requirements for Union goods arriving directly by road or by air. Non-Union goods on board those vehicles/planes (with exception of goods that remain on board at the first point of entry and are just being unloaded) will already be controlled under the Union Transit system and will have to be brought to the appropriate Office of destination under that procedure.

Controls in relation to national prohibitions and restrictions are possible but only where the officer has reasonable grounds for considering that a particular vessel may have prohibited/restricted goods on board – systematic stopping of traffic is contrary to the Single Market concept.

2.6 Place at which goods may be imported

Approval of places within customs ports and airports (Section 7(1), 8(1) and 10(4) of the Customs Act 2015 and Articles 133, 135 and 139 of the UCC provide for the approval of place within customs ports and airports at which goods may be imported).